

## Recommended buys

The very best products you can buy right now spanning across 10 popular tech categories.



## Countryman S E

Car maker Mini unveiled its first hybrid all-wheel-drive vehicle the Countryman S E at the LA Auto Show. <http://digit.in/miniCSE>

Agent 001

attention to the keyboard. Make sure it has a dedicated number pad, and all the keys are full-sized. The arrow keys and WASD keys especially should be uncompromised. Also, you need to invest in a proper gaming mouse, if the laptop doesn't come with one.

### Display

Touchscreens don't matter on a gaming laptop. The glossy or matte finish won't be a choice, but you need to ensure your gaming laptop comes with at least 1920x1080 pixel resolution screen. However, remember that a 1366x768 pixel resolution screen will let you get

away with an inferior GPU, in case you're cash-strapped. But try to get a 1080p Full HD screen.

### Trade-offs

A gaming laptop will never offer great battery life, as battery life's directly related to a laptop's internal hardware. Since gaming laptops pack more firepower to conquer games, their battery life isn't great. A gaming laptop selling for Rs 40k is a misnomer – the high-end internal hardware necessary for laptop to offer acceptable gaming performance can't sell at the entry-level or budget range.

## Conclusion

So given that you're a gamer, look to have a gaming laptop with at least NVIDIA's 960M (or higher) or AMD's R7, R9 GPU. Nothing less will do, and don't be cheap. Don't skimp on the essentials, of course – Intel Core i5 / i7 CPU, at least 8GB of DDR3/DDR4 RAM, 32GB SSD + 1TB hard drive. Plenty of connectivity ports to hook up a decent gaming mouse and headphones. A keyboard with isolated keys, dedicated numpad and full-sized arrow keys is a must as well. Once you have located a device with all of that, unleash the gamer in you. Happy gaming! 

## Wi-Fi woes

I'm planning to buy a Wi-Fi router to hook all my devices to it. I have done some research and found out that 802.11ac is the latest generation and it's a bit faster as compared to older ones.

Now here's my problem, the 'ac' router is supposed to connect to only 'ac' supported devices. But on some websites, I have seen that the 'ac' routers are backwards compatible to n/g/b devices. I own a ASUS ZenFone 5 (I know it's old) and it doesn't support the 'ac'. So, should I get an 'ac' router or go with the 'n/b/g' one instead? Also, are the 802.11ac really faster than the 802.11n? Which brand should I go for? I have seen the prices of different brands and it's almost the same. My budget is ₹2000. Thank You in Advance.

–Chaitanya

 Yes ac is faster than a, b, g and n. You get higher bandwidth only if the device you're connecting is ac supported otherwise it will bottleneck to



A router can make all the difference

the device's Wi-Fi supported standard. But you might upgrade your phone sooner or later. So to future-proof it's best to go for an ac router. We'd recommend the TP-Link Archer C20 AC750. It's dual-band and can read serve USB data to the network. It's within your budget too.

## Quality HDMI cable

Please suggest a good HDMI cable to connect my set-top-box and PS3 to my TV. I've heard that AmazonBasics



Yup AmazonBasics isn't bad at all

HDMI cables are good but they are expensive. Also, please suggest a good USB OTG cable that can be used on Samsung, Sony, Lenovo and Redmi phones or tablets.

–Eric

 Hey Eric, although you'll be able to find cheap HDMI cables online, they might not be of the best quality. With time, the ports malfunction and the cables wear off. AmazonBasics

ensures quality and safety standards, with gold-plated connectors that extends the life and also transmits better signals. Hence, it's better to invest more into cables. Look out for lightning deals on AmazonBasics, since they are quite frequent. For USB cables, you can again check out the same section.

## Audio gear wanted

Dear Headphone guy, I'm planning to purchase a headphone with wireless connectivity, and in-built mic and my budget is ₹1,300. Which one should I go for?

–Manoj

 Greetings from the headphone guy. You'll find the market crowded with hundreds of wireless headsets and at such a budget it's a little difficult to find good quality ones. If you can extend your budget to around ₹1,699, then you can go for the TAGG T-08-G. Not the best ones around out there, but it has all the features you require and also comes along with loads of accessories

such as extra earbuds, ear wings, ear hooks, and a handy zipper bag. If you want better quality, you'll have to extend your budget further to around ₹2,220 for the Philips SHB 5250BK. 



Go for these